

Chapter

The First War of Independence 1857

1. Who organized the Grand Delhi Durbar?

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|-----------------|--------------------|
| (a) Lord Curzon | (b) Lord Canning |
| (c) Lord Lytton | (d) Lord Dalhousie |

MAIN 2024

2. The East India Company's territorial power began to increase rapidly in India after which of the following Battles?

- (a) The battle of Buxar
- (b) The Battle Plassey
- (c) The First Anglo-Mysore War
- (d) The Third Anglo-Maratha War

MAIN 2024

3. Imagine you are an Indian ruler who has signed the Subsidiary Alliance. Mention any two conditions of this agreement which will affect you.

MAIN 2024

4. The Revolt of 1857 was the beginning of the independence struggle against the colonial rule of the British. With reference to the consequences of the Revolt, answer the following:

- (i) Mention any three changes made in the administration with the end of the Company's Rule.
- (ii) State any three policies promised to Indians in Queen Victoria's Proclamation.
- (iii) Mention any four changes made in the army after the Revolt.

MAIN 2024

5. Under the Government of India Act 1858, who gave up the direct administration of India?

- (a) The East India Company
- (b) The British Crown
- (c) Lord Mountbatten
- (d) The Mughal Emperor

COMP 2024

6. The Indian Nationalists described the Great Uprising of 1857 as the First War of Independence. With reference to this, answer the following questions:

(i) Mention any three policies used by the British to expand their political power in India.

(ii) The Revolt of 1857 is also known as the Sepoy Mutiny. Mention any three military causes which led to the uprising.

(iii) Mention any four economic causes of the Revolt.

MAIN 2023

7. After the initial success of the Uprising of 1857, the objective of the leaders of the Uprising included

- (a) Restoring the former glory to the Mughal empire;
- (b) Forming a federation of Indian States under the aegis of Bhadur Shah II;
- (c) Eliminating foreign rule and return of the old order;
- (d) Establishing his own power in his respective region by each leader.

MAIN 2022

8. Mention any two social reforms advocated by the British which affected the religious traditions of the Indian people.

COMP 2021

Solution

1.

Ans: (c) Lord Lytton

Explanation:

The **Grand Delhi Durbar** was organized in **1877** by **Lord Lytton**, who was the Viceroy of India at that time. The Durbar was held to formally proclaim **Queen Victoria as the Empress of India**, and to display the **prestige and power of the British Empire**.

Thus, the correct option is **(c)**.

2.

Ans: (b) The Battle of Plassey

Explanation:

The **Battle of Plassey**, fought in **1757**, marked the beginning of the East India Company's rapid territorial expansion in India. After this victory, the Company gained control over **Bengal**, which provided them with great wealth and resources.

This enabled the Company to strengthen its army and expand its influence in other regions of India.

Thus, the correct option is **(b)**.

3.

Ans:

(i) I must allow a **British Resident and troops** to stay in my territory, which reduces my control over my own administration.

(ii) I cannot form **alliances or wage wars** without British permission, which greatly limits my political freedom.

4.

Ans:

(i) Any three changes made in the administration after the end of the **Company's Rule**:

(a) End of East India Company's Rule: The Government of India Act, 1858 ended Company rule and transferred the administration of India to the **British Crown**.

(b) Secretary of State for India: A new office called the **Secretary of State for India** was created, assisted by a council to control Indian administration from London.

(c) Governor-General became Viceroy: The Governor-General was given the title of **Viceroy**, who became the direct representative of the British Crown in India.

(ii) Any three policies promised to Indians in Queen Victoria's Proclamation:

(a) Equality before Law: The Queen promised **equal treatment** to Indians and Europeans, without discrimination based on race, caste, or religion.

(b) Non-interference in Religion: The British assured that they would **not interfere in religious matters**, to remove fears that had caused the Revolt.

(c) Respect for Princely States: Indian princes were assured that their **rights and territories would be respected** if they remained loyal to the British.

(iii) Any four changes made in the army after the Revolt:

(a) Increase in European soldiers: The British increased the **number of European troops** to reduce the chances of future rebellions.

(b) Europeans in key positions: High-ranking posts in the army were reserved for **Europeans**, limiting Indians from gaining power.

(c) Divide and Rule Policy: The army was reorganized on the basis of **caste, religion, and region** to prevent unity among Indian soldiers.

(d) Disbanding of Indian regiments: Many Indian regiments that participated in the Revolt were **disbanded**, while loyal ones (like the Gurkhas) were retained.

5.

Ans: (a) The East India Company

Explanation:

Under the **Government of India Act of 1858**, the **East India Company ended its direct rule** over India. The administration was transferred to the **British Crown**, bringing India under direct control of the British government.

Thus, the correct option is **(a)**.

6.

Ans:

(i) Three policies used by the British to expand their political power in India:

(a) Doctrine of Lapse: This policy allowed the British to annex Indian states that had no natural male heir to the throne, such as Jhansi and Satara.

(b) Subsidiary Alliance: Indian rulers were forced to accept British troops in their territory and pay for their maintenance, which reduced their independence.

(c) Annexation of States: The British annexed states on the grounds of misgovernment, such as in the case of the annexation of Awadh.

(ii) Three military causes which led to the Revolt of 1857:

(a) Discrimination: Indian soldiers received lower pay and faced discrimination in promotions compared to British soldiers.

(b) General Service Enlistment Act (1856): This Act required Indian soldiers to serve overseas, which hurt their religious beliefs.

(c) Greased Cartridges Issue: The cartridges of the new Enfield rifle were believed to be greased with cow and pig fat, which offended both Hindu and Muslim soldiers.

(iii) Four economic causes of the Revolt:

(a) High Taxes: Heavy land revenue policies placed a huge burden on peasants and landlords.

(b) Drain of Wealth: The British extracted India's resources for their own benefit, making India poorer.

(c) Decline of Industries: Cheap British manufactured goods ruined Indian handicrafts and industries, causing unemployment.

(d) Peasant Exploitation: Peasants were heavily taxed and many lost their lands, leading to widespread poverty and discontent.

7.

Ans: (c) Eliminating foreign rule and return of the old order

Explanation:

After the early success of the **Revolt of 1857**, the leaders aimed to **end British rule in India** and restore the **traditional system of governance** that existed before British control. Their main goal was to remove foreign domination and bring back the old political order.

Thus, the correct option is **(c)**.

8.

Ans: Two social reforms advocated by the British that affected Indian religious traditions were:

(i) Banning of Sati: The British abolished the practice of **Sati**, where widows were forced to burn themselves on their husband's funeral pyre. This interfered with traditional Hindu customs.

(ii) Widow Remarriage: The British passed the **Widow Remarriage Act**, legalizing the remarriage of widows. This challenged long-standing religious beliefs in Hindu society.